



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Marketing-Information Management

APPAREL AND ACCESSORIES MARKETING EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Describe the need for marketing data.
2. Determine customer/client needs.
3. Discuss the nature of sampling plans (i.e., who, how many, how chosen).
4. Describe data-collection methods (e.g., observations, mail, diaries, telephone, Internet, discussion groups, interviews, scanners, tracking tools).
5. Identify ways to track marketing-communications activities.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the Marketing Manager for URBAN EDGE, a fast-fashion retail chain with 50 locations and a strong online presence. The Director of Merchandising (judge) wants you to design a research study to gauge customer interest in a new "Buy-Back & Resale" program.

URBAN EDGE is known for selling trendy, affordable clothing to teens and young adults. However, the company has faced recent criticism on social media regarding textile waste. To improve the brand's image and drive foot traffic, executives are considering a pilot program where customers can return used URBAN EDGE clothing in exchange for store credit. These items would then be cleaned and sold in a "Vintage Vault" section of the store at a discount.

The Director of Merchandising (judge) is hesitant. They are worried that selling used clothes might "cheaper" the brand image or cannibalize sales of new arrivals (meaning customers might buy the cheaper used items instead of the new full-price items).

Before launching this pilot in stores, the Director (judge) wants data. They have asked you to create a marketing research plan to determine if the target market actually wants to buy used clothes from URBAN EDGE, and how much credit they would expect for trading in items.

You will present your plan to the Director (judge) in a role-play taking place in their office. Your plan must include:

- A sampling plan: Will you survey current loyal customers, or people who have stopped shopping with us? How will you reach them?
- Data-collection methods: Will you use digital surveys, in-store interviews, or social media polling?
- Specific questions: What will you ask to determine if a "Vintage Vault" will hurt the brand's image?
- Incentives: How will you get young, busy customers to actually provide this feedback?

The Director (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your proposal. After you have presented, the Director will ask questions and then conclude the meeting.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How can our store employees help us solicit this feedback without slowing down the checkout lines?

2. Our target demographic is very busy. How can we encourage them to actually take the time to participate in this market research?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Describe the need for marketing data?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Determine customer/client needs?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Discuss the nature of sampling plans (i.e., who, how many, how chosen)?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Describe data-collection methods (e.g., observations, mail, diaries, telephone, Internet, discussion groups, interviews, scanners, tracking tools)?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Identify ways to track marketing-communications activities?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						